

Google Business Profile Setup Guide

A complete step-by-step playbook to rank higher in Newton, NC and surrounding areas for Renegade Wellness Center.

 Newton, NC & Surrounding Areas  10 Steps to Follow

 ~2-3 Hours to Complete

≡ What's Covered

- 1 Claim & Verify Your Profile
- 2 Complete Every Info Field
- 3 Choose the Right Categories
- 4 Write a Keyword-Rich Description
- 5 Add Photos & Videos
- 6 Add Services & Products

- 6 Add Services & Products
- 7 Get & Respond to Reviews
- 8 Post Regular Updates
- 9 Build Local Citations
- 10 Track & Maintain Performance

1

STEP ONE

Claim & Verify Your Google Business Profile

1 **Go to Google Business Profile**

Visit **business.google.com** and sign in with the Google account you want associated with the business (ideally a dedicated business Gmail account).

2 **Search for Your Business**

Type "**Renegade Wellness Center**" in the search bar. If it appears, click *Claim this business*. If it doesn't exist yet, click *Add your business to Google*.

3 **Choose Your Verification Method**

Google will offer one or more options: **Postcard by mail** (most common — arrives in 5–14 days), **Phone call**, **Email**, or **Video call**. Postcard is the most reliable for brick-and-mortar businesses.

4 **Enter the Verification Code**

Once you receive your postcard, log back in to **business.google.com**, navigate to your profile, and enter the 5-digit code. Your profile is now verified and trusted by Google.



Don't make major changes while waiting for verification.

Significant edits can reset the verification process and require starting over.



Already claimed? Check if someone else (maybe a prior owner or Google itself) has already claimed the listing. If so, click *Request Access* and Google will email the current owner to transfer ownership.

2

STEP TWO

Complete Every Business Info Field

Google rewards completeness. The more fields you fill out, the higher your local ranking signals. Go to your dashboard and fill in all of the following:



Business Name

Use your exact legal name: **Renegade Wellness Center**. Do NOT add keywords to your business name (e.g., "Renegade Wellness Center Salt Therapy Newton NC") — Google may suspend your listing for this.



Address

Enter your full Newton, NC address exactly as it appears on your website and other directories. Consistency across the web is critical for local SEO trust signals.



Phone Number

Use a **local Newton, NC phone number** (not a toll-free number). This confirms to Google that you are truly a local business. Make sure this number matches your website exactly.



Website URL

Link directly to **renegadewellnesscenter.com**. Make sure the URL you enter is your homepage URL exactly as it appears (with or without trailing slash, consistently).



Business Hours

Set accurate regular hours AND use the *Special Hours* feature for holidays and events. Customers who see outdated hours leave bad reviews. Enable **More hours** to also add appointment-only hours if applicable.



Appointment Link

Add your booking URL under *Booking* in the profile. This adds a visible **"Book"** button on your Google listing — huge for converting searchers into clients.



NAP Consistency is critical. Your Name, Address, and Phone number must be *identical* across Google, your website, Facebook, Yelp, and every other directory. Even small differences (St. vs Street, Suite vs Ste.) can hurt your ranking.

3

STEP THREE

Choose the Right Categories

Categories tell Google what your business does and directly impact which searches you show up in. You get one **Primary Category** and up to 9 additional categories.

★ **Recommended Primary Category**

"Wellness Center" — This is the broadest, most accurate match for Renegade Wellness Center and signals your core service to Google.

+ **Recommended Additional Categories**

Add as many relevant secondary categories as apply. These expand your search visibility:

Spa Alternative Medicine Practitioner

Health Consultant Massage Therapist Sauna

Physical Therapist Holistic Medicine Practitioner



Pro tip: Search each category name in Google and look at the local results. If your competitors are appearing there, it's likely the right category for you to use too.

4

STEP FOUR

Write a Keyword-Rich Business Description

Your description (up to 750 characters) is read by Google and potential customers. It should naturally include location keywords and your core services.



Sample Description (customize as needed)

"Renegade Wellness Center is Newton, NC's premier destination for holistic health and relaxation. We offer salt cabin therapy, infrared therapy, and wellness packages designed to help you detox, de-stress, and restore balance. Serving Newton, Conover, Hickory, Catawba County, and surrounding areas. Book your session today and experience the healing power of halotherapy and infrared light therapy."

Target keywords to weave in naturally:



Salt therapy Newton NC



Infrared therapy Hickory NC



Wellness center Catawba
County



Halotherapy near me



Salt cabin therapy NC



Infrared sauna Newton NC



Holistic wellness Conover
NC



Relaxation spa Newton NC



Avoid keyword stuffing. Write for humans first. Google's algorithm detects unnatural phrasing and it can harm your ranking instead of helping.

5

STEP FIVE

Add High-Quality Photos & Videos

Businesses with photos get **42% more requests for directions** and **35% more website clicks**. Google favors profiles with regular, recent photo uploads.

REQUIRED

Cover Photo

REQUIRED

Logo / Profile Photo

INTERIOR

Salt Cabin Room

INTERIOR

Infrared Therapy Room

EXTERIOR

Front of Building

PRODUCTS

Retail Products

ATMOSPHERE

Waiting Area / Lobby

TEAM

Staff Photos



Photo Quality Requirements

Use high-resolution images (minimum **720px wide**). JPG or PNG format. Well-lit, professional-looking shots. Avoid stock photos — Google and customers prefer authentic images.



Add a Short Video

A 30–90 second walkthrough video of the salt cabin or infrared room dramatically increases engagement. Upload it directly to your GBP — Google prominently displays videos in the profile.



Upload Regularly

Aim to add at least **2–4 new photos per month**. Google notices recent activity and it's a signal of an active, trustworthy business. New seasonal décor, events, product arrivals — all count.

6

STEP SIX

Add Services & Products

The **Services** and **Products** sections appear directly on your Google listing and help match your profile to more specific searches.



Add Your Core Services

Under *Edit Profile* → *Services*, add each service with a name, description, and price. Include:

Salt Cabin Session Infrared Therapy Session

Salt Cabin + Infrared Combo



Add Retail Products (Optional but Helpful)

Under *Edit Profile* → *Products*, list your main product categories with photos and descriptions. Google can surface individual products in search results: **Essential Oils, Supplements, CBD Products, Himalayan Salt Products, Candles**, etc.



Write Detailed Service Descriptions

For each service, write 2–3 sentences describing what it is, the benefits, and who it's for. Example for Salt Cabin: *"Experience the healing benefits of halotherapy in our private salt cabin. Ideal for respiratory support, skin conditions, stress relief, and relaxation. Sessions available for 1–2 guests."*

Get Reviews & Respond to Every Single One

Reviews are one of the **top 3 ranking factors** for local SEO. Both the quantity and quality of reviews — and whether you respond — affect your ranking.



Get Your Review Link

In your GBP dashboard, click *Ask for Reviews*. Copy your unique review link. This takes customers directly to the review form — no hunting required.



Ask After Every Session

Train yourself (or staff) to verbally ask happy clients to leave a review as they check out. Send a follow-up text or email with the link. The best time to ask is when the client is most excited — right after their session.



Create a QR Code Card

Use a free tool like [qr-code-generator.com](https://www.qr-code-generator.com) to make a QR code from your review link. Print small cards and place them at the front desk, in the salt cabin, or hand them to clients at checkout.



Respond to EVERY Review

Google rewards businesses that engage with reviewers. **For 5-star reviews:** Thank them warmly, mention a specific detail from their review, invite them back. **For negative reviews:** Respond calmly, apologize for their experience, offer to resolve it offline — never argue publicly.

 DON'T DO THIS

Never offer discounts or incentives in exchange for reviews. Google will remove them and may penalize your account.

 TARGET

Aim for at least 10–15 reviews in your first 90 days. Then 2–4 new reviews per month to stay active.

 QUICK WIN

Ask 5 long-time loyal clients right away. Early reviews build a strong foundation fast.

8

STEP EIGHT

Post Regular Google Business Updates

Google Posts appear on your listing and show that your business is active. They also give you another opportunity to rank for keywords and drive clicks.



Post Types to Use

What's New — Share general updates about the business. **Offer** — Promote a sale or special package deal. **Event** — Promote wellness events, open houses, or seasonal specials. **Product** — Highlight a specific product or service.



Post Frequency

Aim for **at least 1–2 posts per week**. Google Posts expire after 7 days (except Events and Offers), so regular posting is needed to keep your listing looking active.



Post Ideas for Renegade Wellness Center

Holiday Salt Cabin specials • Infrared therapy benefits tips • New product arrivals • Customer testimonials (with permission) • Seasonal wellness reminders • "Book this week and save" offers • Himalayan salt product highlights.



Always Include a Call-to-Action Button

Every post lets you add a button: **Book, Order Online, Learn More, Sign Up, Call Now**. Always add one — it directly drives conversions from your Google listing.

9

STEP NINE

Build Local Citations & Consistency

A **citation** is any online mention of your business name, address, and phone number. The more consistent citations you have across trusted directories, the more Google trusts your location data.

Top directories to get listed on:

- ☐ **Yelp** — yelp.com/biz/add
- ☐ **Bing Places** — bingplaces.com (Microsoft's version of GBP)
- ☐ **Apple Maps** — mapsconnect.apple.com
- ☐ **Facebook Business Page** — facebook.com/business
- ☐ **Nextdoor** — nextdoor.com/business (hyperlocal — great for Newton)
- ☐ **Foursquare** — foursquare.com/add-place
- ☐ **Yellow Pages** — yp.com
- ☐ **Better Business Bureau** — bbb.org
- ☐ **Chamber of Commerce** — Newton/Catawba County Chamber listing
- ☐ **Thumbtack / Alignable** — Good for local business networking



Critical: Use the *exact same* business name, address, and phone number on every single directory. Even minor formatting differences can dilute your local SEO signals.



Use a spreadsheet to track which directories you've been listed on, your login credentials, and when you last updated each one. This will save you a lot of time down the road.

10

Track Performance & Keep the Profile Maintained

Setting up your profile is the beginning, not the end. Ongoing maintenance and monitoring is what keeps you ranking above competitors over time.



Monitor GBP Insights Weekly

Your GBP dashboard shows: **how many people found you**, what search terms they used, how many clicked for directions, how many called, and how many visited your website. Check this weekly.



Set Up Google Search Console

Go to **search.google.com/search-console** and verify your website. This shows you which Google search queries are bringing people to your site — invaluable for knowing what people in Newton/Hickory are searching for.



Check for Unauthorized Edits

Google allows users and even Google itself to suggest edits to your listing. Check your profile monthly and review any pending edits. Incorrect hours, wrong addresses, or wrong categories can all hurt you.



Keep Hours Updated

Update holiday hours before every major holiday. A customer who shows up during closed hours because Google showed wrong hours = a likely 1-star review. Use the *Special Hours* feature proactively.

Recommended Maintenance Schedule:



Weekly

Add 1–2 Google Posts. Respond to any new reviews. Check for new questions in the Q&A section.



Bi-Weekly

Upload 2–4 new photos. Review GBP Insights for trends in search queries and user actions.



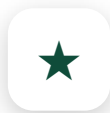
Monthly

Review and verify all business info is accurate. Check for unauthorized edits. Review citation directories for inconsistencies.



Quarterly

Audit your full GBP profile for completeness. Update photos seasonally. Review competitor profiles and look for category or service gaps you can fill.



BONUS TIPS

Extra Local SEO Wins for Newton, NC



Add Location Pages to Your Website

Create a page on your website titled something like **"Wellness Center Serving Newton, Conover, Hickory & Catawba County"**. This page should mention each city naturally and link to your GBP. Google uses website content to reinforce location relevance.



Answer Questions in the Q&A Section

Anyone can ask questions on your GBP listing. *You* should be the one answering them — and you can even post your own frequently asked questions and answer them yourself. This content is indexed by Google.



Use "Near Me" Keywords on Your Website

On your website's homepage and service pages, naturally include phrases like *"salt therapy near Newton NC"*, *"infrared therapy near Hickory NC"*, and *"wellness center near me in Catawba County"*. This reinforces your GBP signals.



Embed a Google Map on Your Website

Go to **maps.google.com**, search your business, click Share → Embed a map, and paste the code into your website's contact page. This creates a direct link signal between your website and your GBP listing.



Get a Local News or Community Mention

Reach out to local Newton/Catawba County news sites, community Facebook groups, or the local Chamber of Commerce for a feature or mention. These backlinks from local authoritative sources are gold for local SEO.

Renegade Wellness Center

Google Business Profile SEO Guide — Newton, NC

Questions or updates? Reach out to your web developer to keep **renegadewellnesscenter.com** in sync with your GBP.